

Intern Interview Experience – Barclays

About the Company:

Barclays is a British multinational bank founded in 1690 and headquartered in London, with operations in nearly 40 countries and serving around 48 million customers. Known for historic firsts—like funding the world's first industrial steam railway and launching the world's first ATM in 1967—it today offers services spanning retail and corporate banking, investment banking, and wealth management. With assets exceeding £1.5 trillion, Barclays is doubling down on innovation: backing AI startups, driving open banking, and committing over \$1 trillion to sustainable finance by 2030. It continues to cement its role as a key player in shaping the future of global finance.

There were **two stages** to the selection process:

- ❖ Online Assessment
- ❖ Interviews

Around 450 students applied, and only ~170 were shortlisted for the OA.

Online Assessment

- ❖ Online Assessment was **70 mins for 25 questions: 20 MCQs and 5 SQL queries.**
- ❖ MCQs were based on **OOPS concepts, output prediction, and debugging of C/C++/Java, basic aptitude questions.**
- ❖ The SQL questions, while conceptually simple, were presented in long passages, making them time-consuming. They covered string manipulation, aggregate functions, nested queries/joins, and date/time extraction.
- ❖ It was conducted on the **HackerEarth** platform.
- ❖ **Time management** was essential to this OA. I managed to answer **19 MCQs out of 20 and 4 SQL queries out of 5**

46 students were shortlisted for the interview.

Before the interviews started, we were shown a presentation from the Barclays team about its history, its presence in India and what this intern role entails.

Interview process was split into **2 rounds.**

Round 1: Technical Interview @ CUIC

- ❖ This round started off with a self-introduction in which I explained my projects briefly and my interests in AI/ML.
- ❖ Then she asked about a project that I had mentioned in my resume and asked me to write its schema on paper. She asked several follow up questions regarding the schema which I was able to answer.
- ❖ She asked me to write a SQL query to find the second largest table in employee table which I did using nested query.
- ❖ She asked how to implement concurrency in MySQL and MongoDB.
- ❖ She asked me to design a URL Shortener, a system design question I wasn't prepared for. I explained how I'd approach it using the MERN stack, describing how shortened URLs would be generated and mapped in the database.
- ❖ She asked how I would solve the shortest path problem and I explained using Dijkstra's Algorithm and she asked me to write the pseudo code.
- ❖ She asked me how multilevel or multiple inheritance is implemented in Java and I explained Java interfaces and their implementations.
- ❖ She then asked me if I had questions and I asked how GenAI being used in modern fintech especially in their company.

25 students were shortlisted for HR round.

Round 2: HR Round @ CUIC

- ❖ For me, the HR round was longer, and I performed better there than in the technical round and the interviewer was friendly so I was able to answer comfortably.
- ❖ It started off with a self-introduction in which I gave an introduction similar to what I did in the first round.
- ❖ Then she moved on and asked me about one of my projects and how you would handle tight deadlines in it. I answered honestly, sharing my experience working under tight deadlines for an NGO project where we had to deliver a prototype within a week.
- ❖ She asked how will I react if your plan for a project did not go according to plan and something broke before final submission. I answered I would try my best to fix it but if I couldn't I would admit something broke in the final moment and ask for a small extension
- ❖ She asked, if while working as an intern in a team, after all project details were finalized, I came up with a better implementation for a module, would I approach my project manager. I answered yes, I would but would not be discouraged if it was rejected because there would be a reason for it and I would learn from it.

- ❖ She asked asked what would you do if you found out your teammate had plagiarized his part of a project after final submission.
- ❖ She asked where I would see myself in 5 years and after I answered she asked me what about in 10 years and I answered that too.
- ❖ She asked me if there are any questions and I asked what challenges would interns face during the internship.

Out of 25 students, **15 students** were finalized for Barclays 2026 Summer Internship Program.

Contact Info: Feel free to reach out to me for anything.

Email: sasikiranl0000@gmail.com

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/sasikiranl/>